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(54) **SIDING INSTALLATION APPARATUS**

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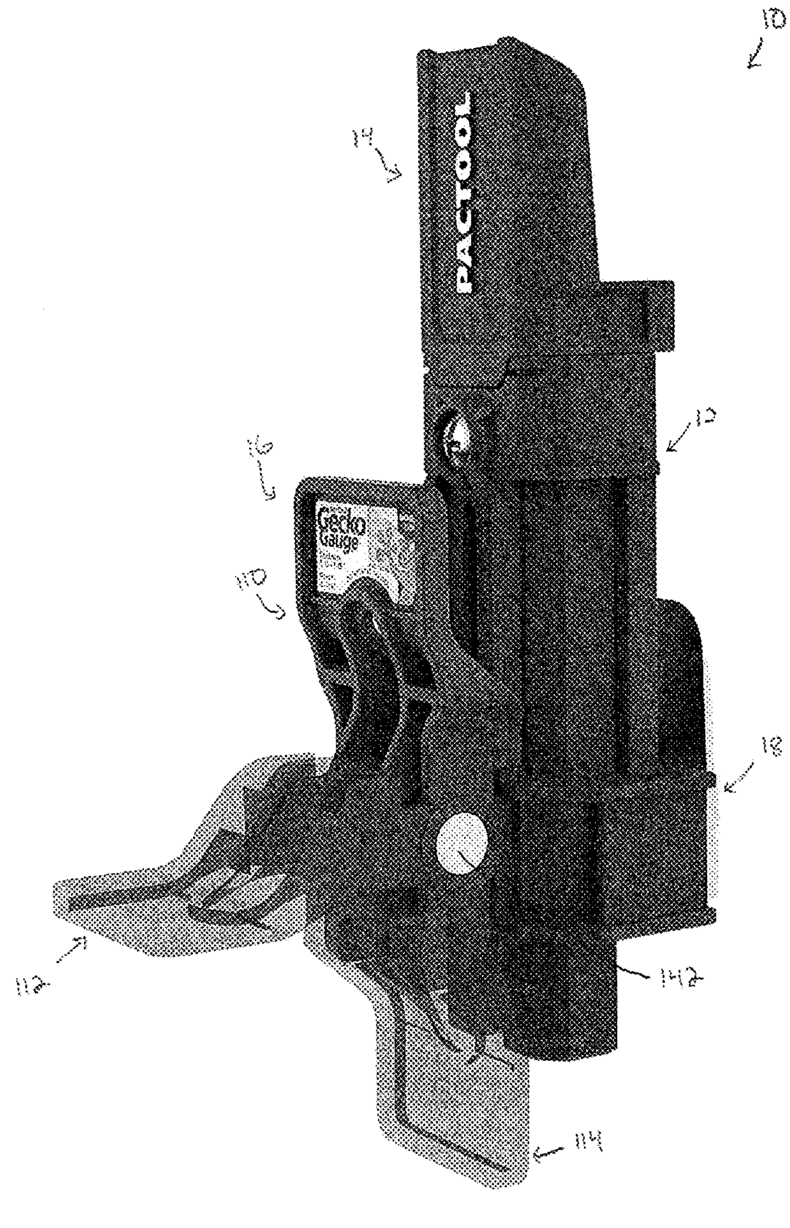
(57) **ABSTRACT**

Provided is a siding gauge including a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage, the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel and each having an angled surface, a lever pivotable relative to the housing, and a pressure plate positioned in the through passage and coupled to the housing by a fastener, the pressure plate having an angled surface to correspond to the angled surface of the pair of legs.



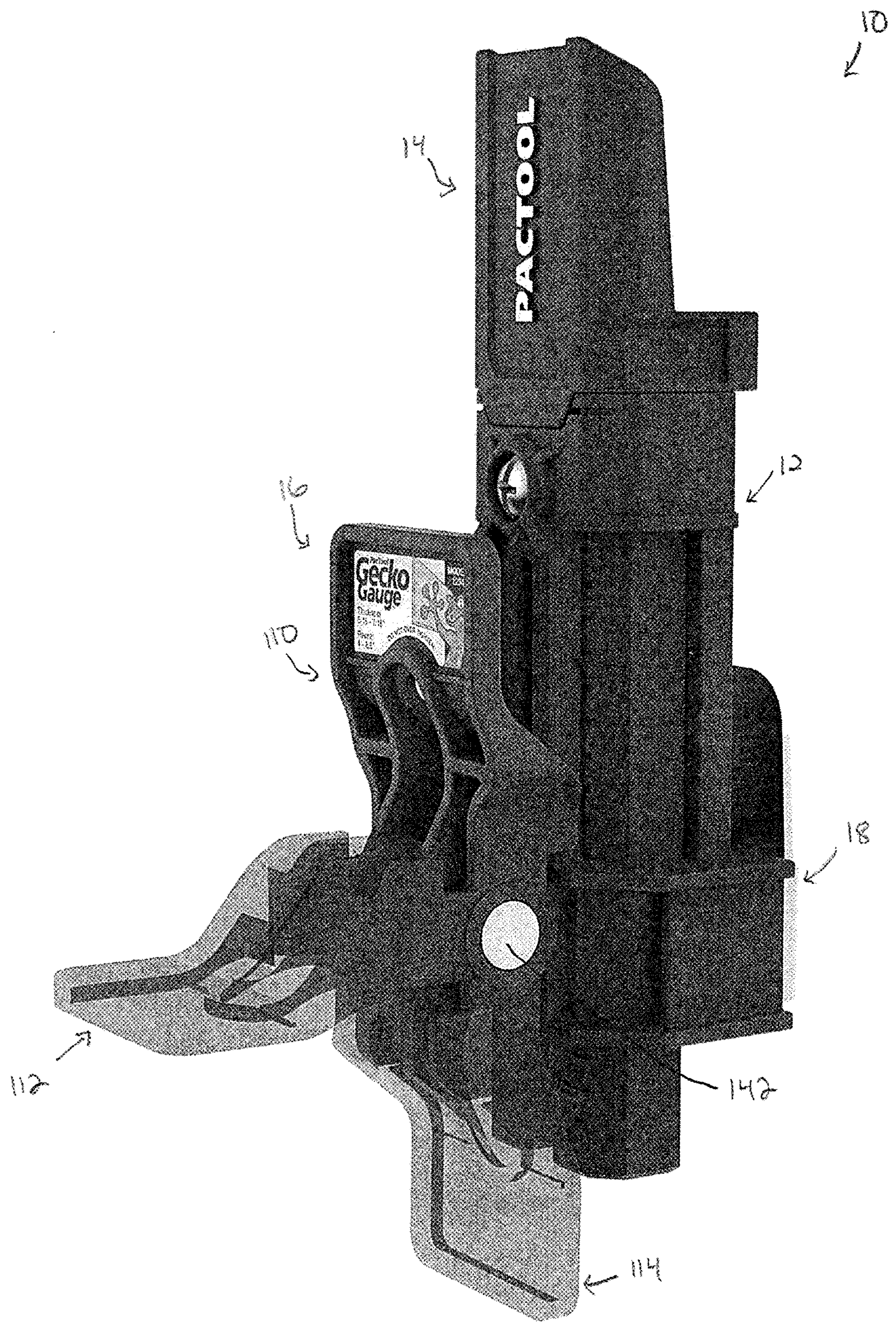


FIG. 1

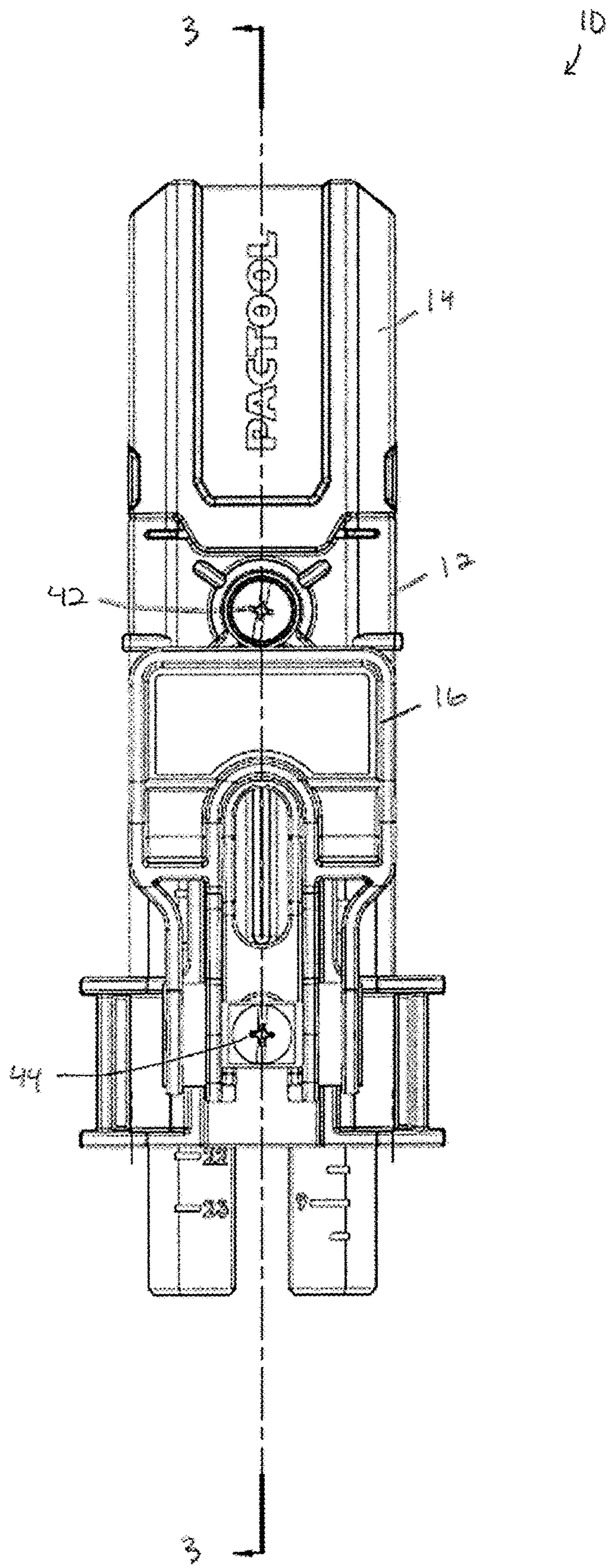


FIG. 2

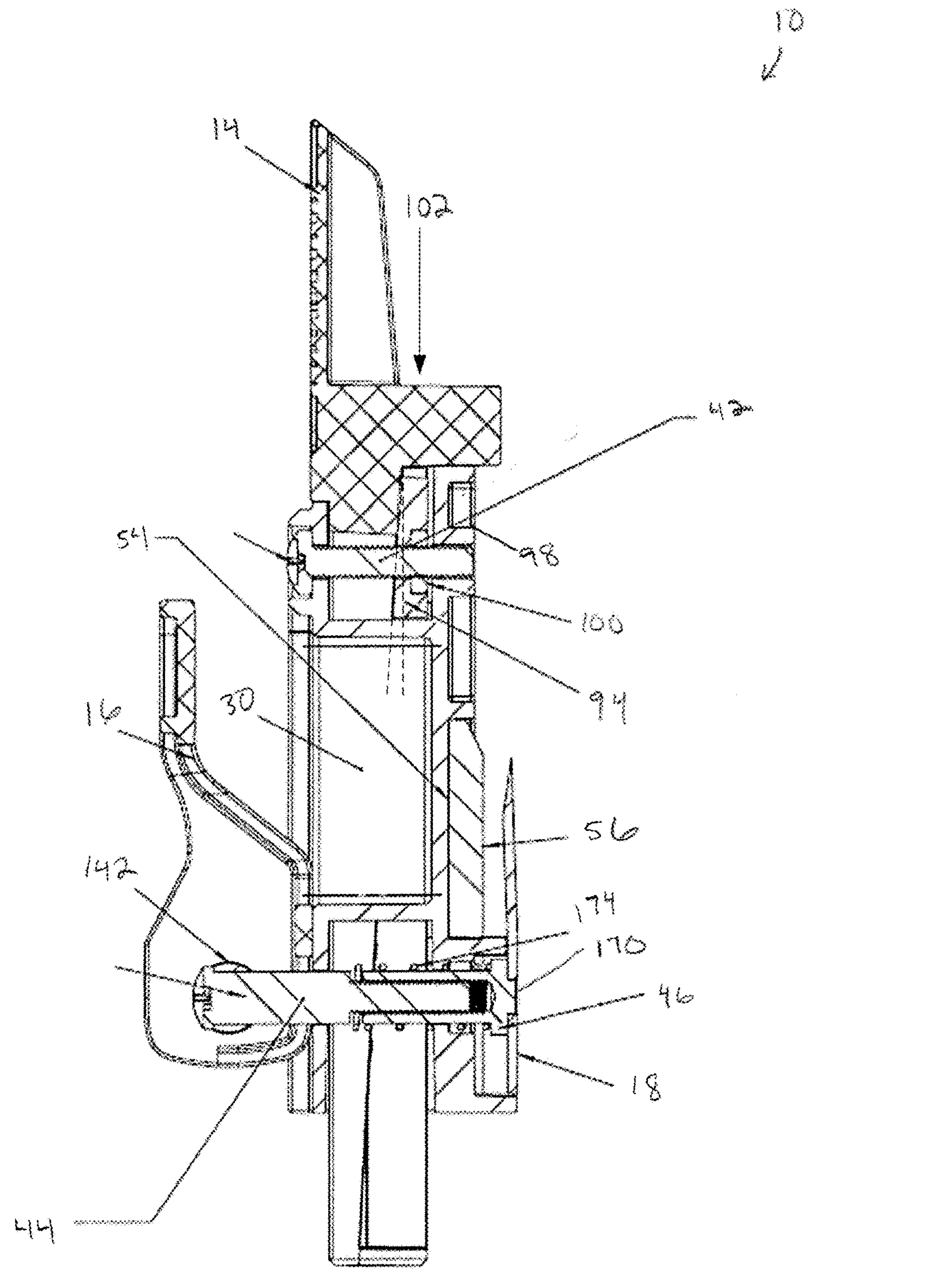


FIG. 3

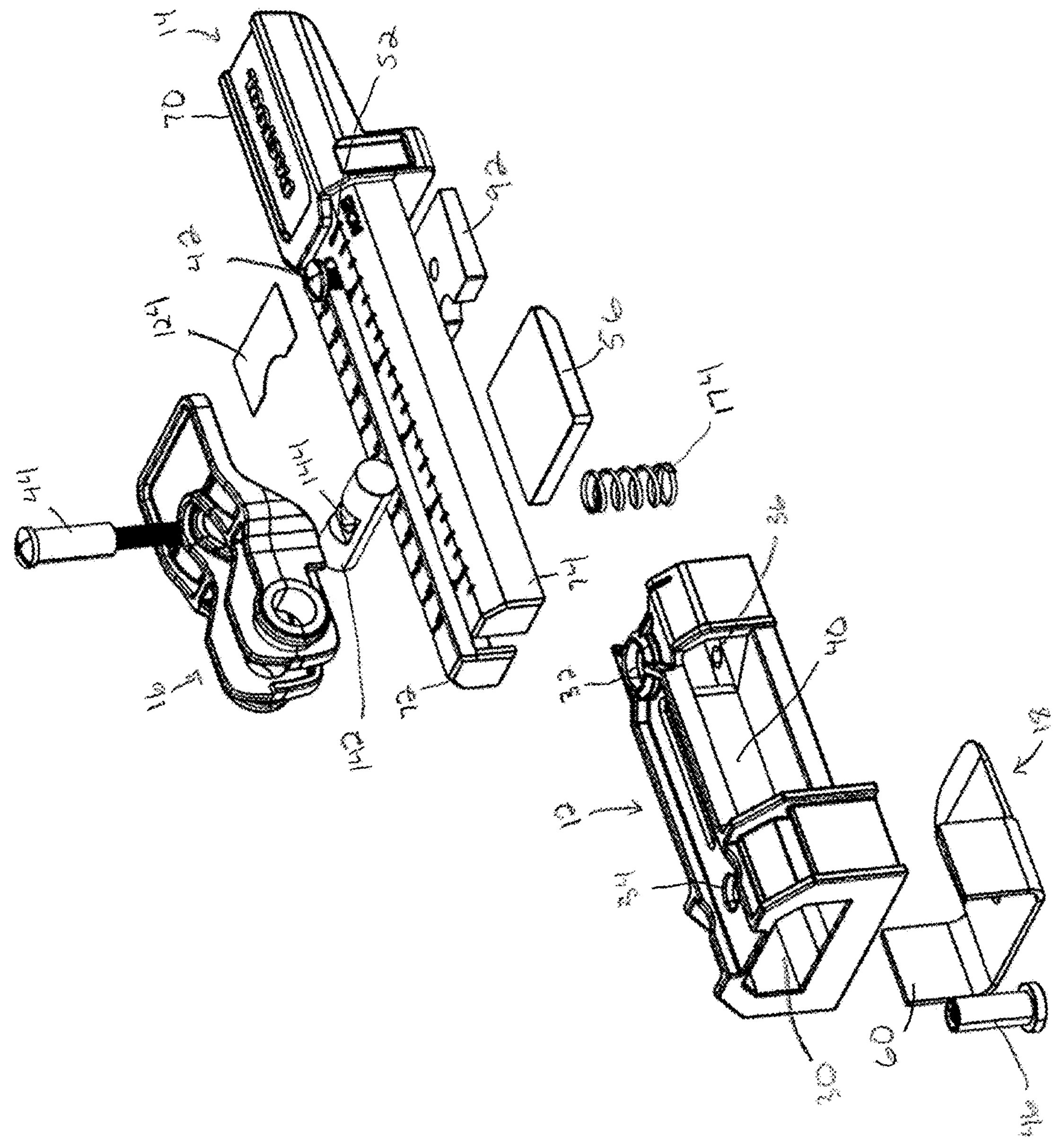

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FIG. 4

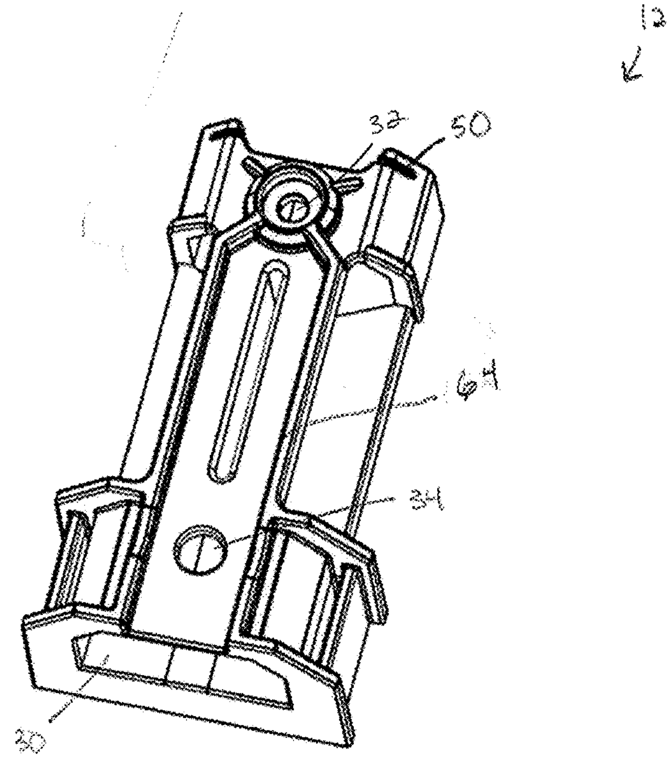

FIG. 5

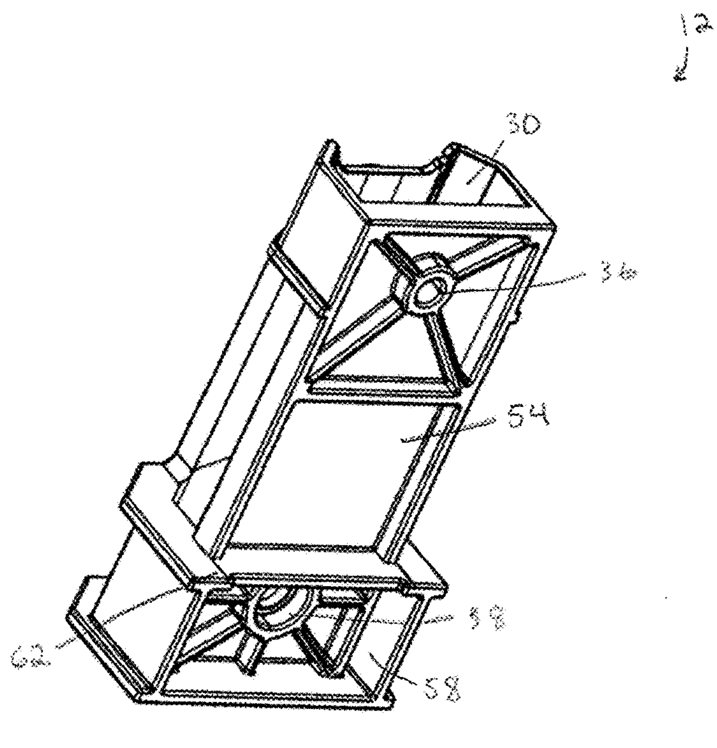

FIG. 6

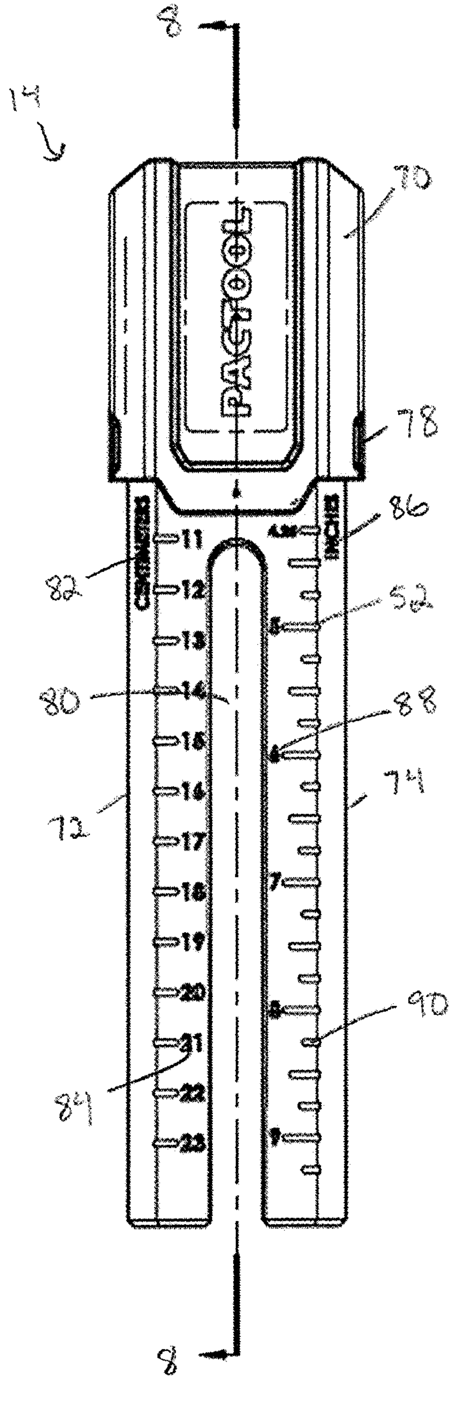

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FIG. 7

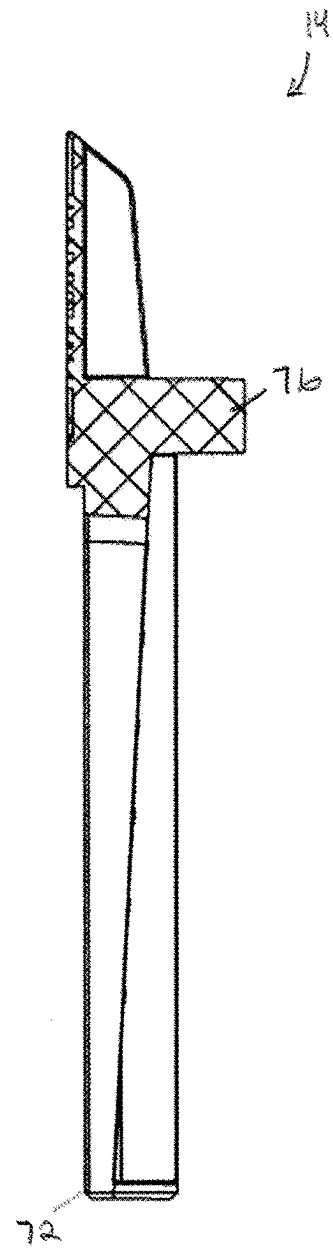

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FIG. 8

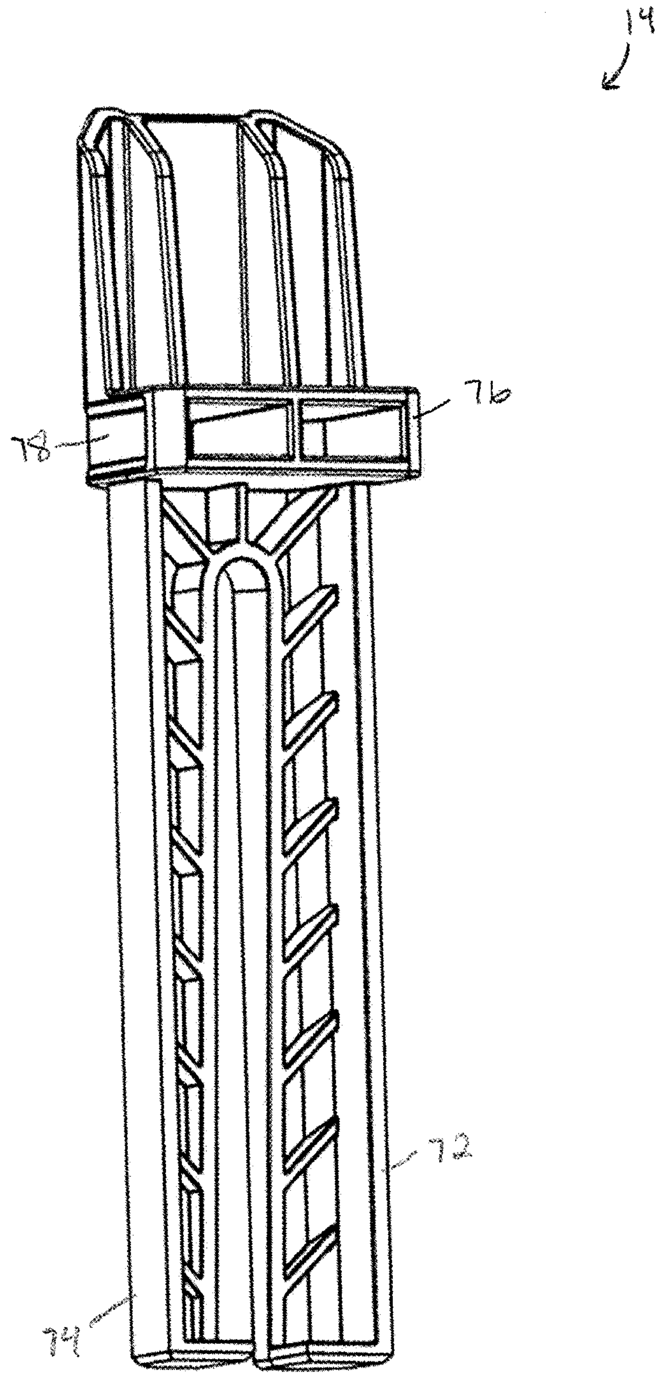

FIG. 9

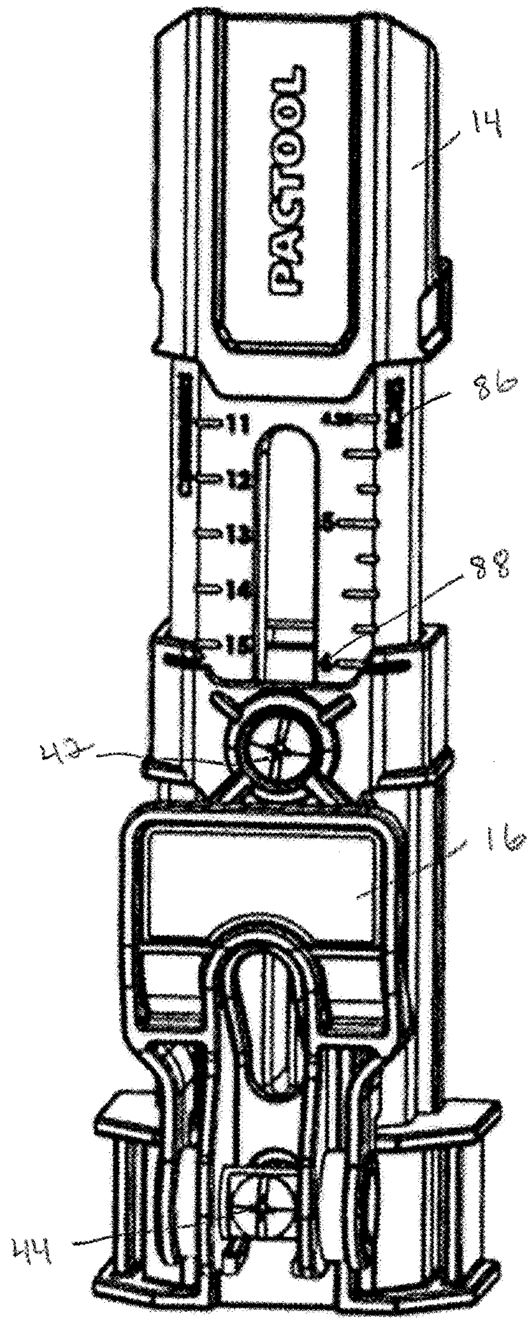

FIG. 10

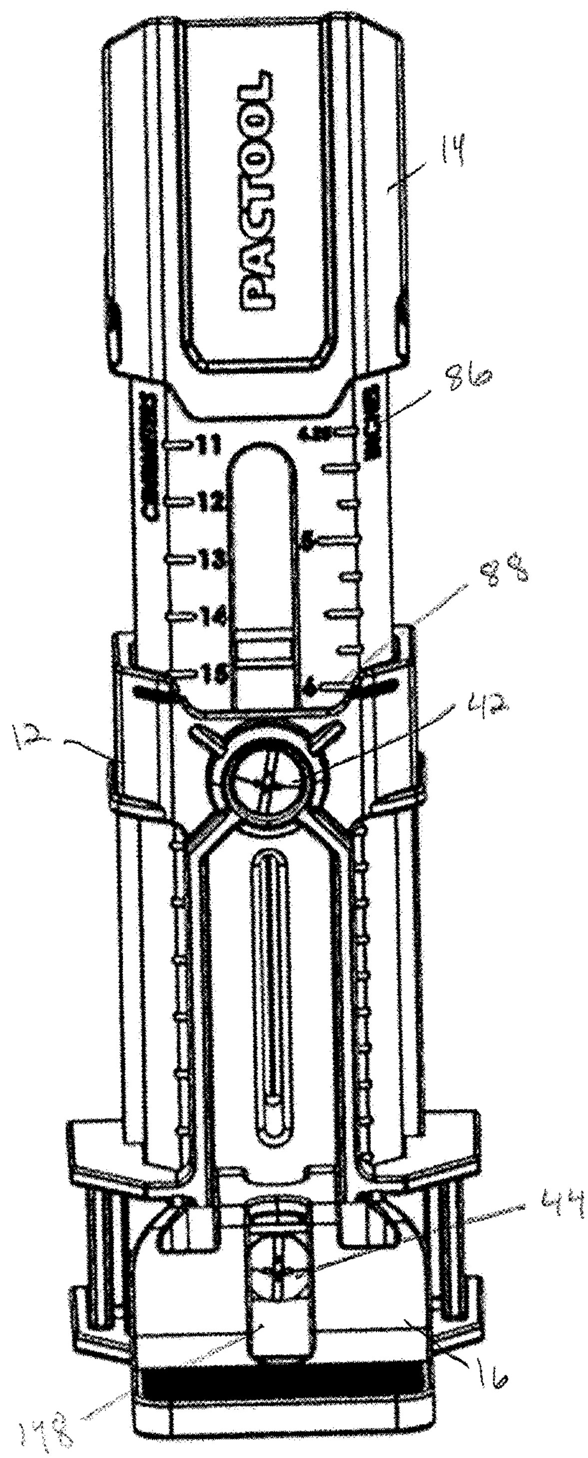

FIG. 11

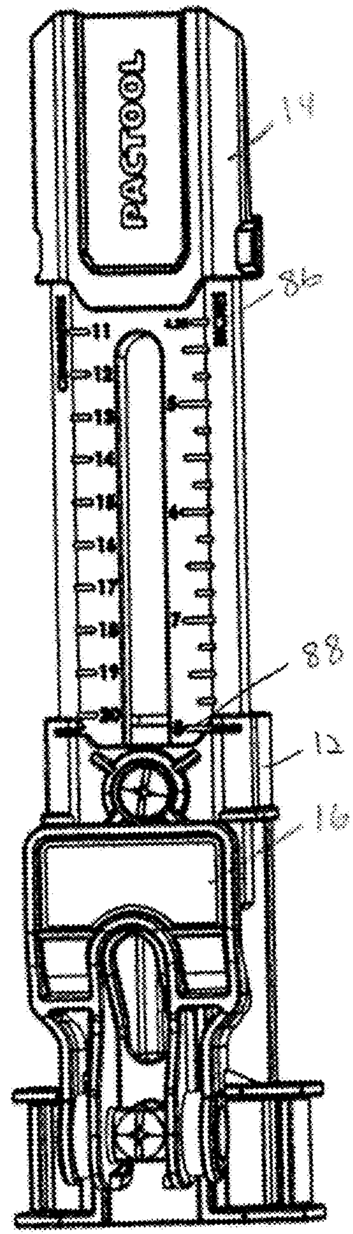

FIG. 12

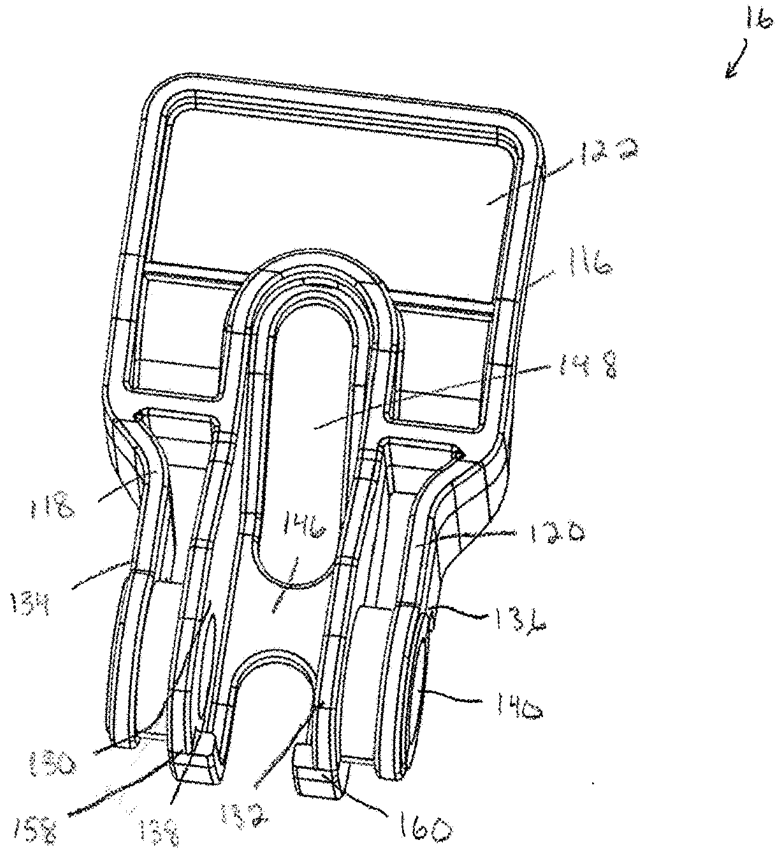
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FIG. 13

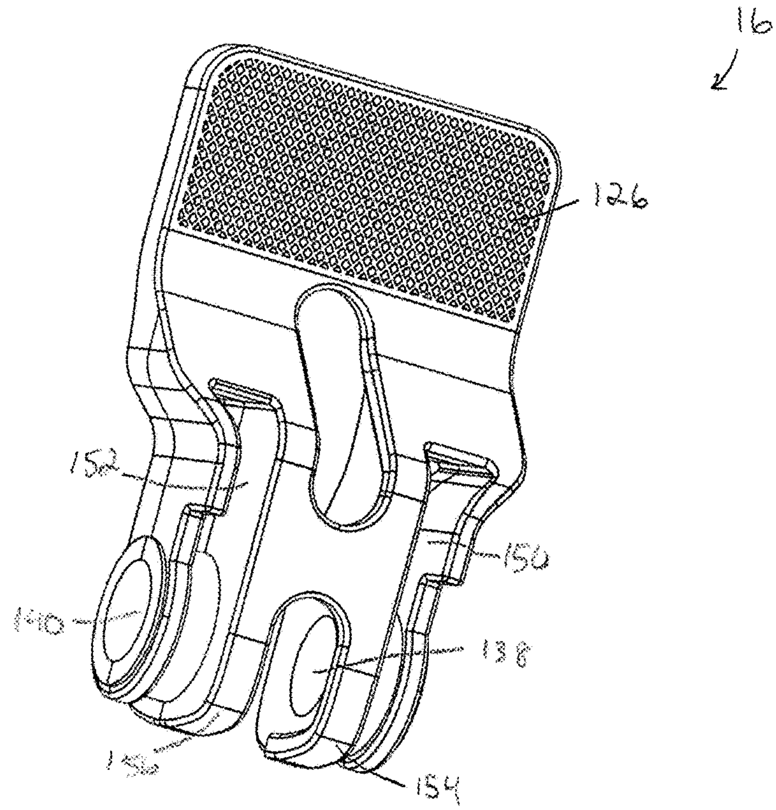
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FIG. 14

SIDING INSTALLATION APPARATUS

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0001] In general, the present invention relates to a siding installation apparatus, and in particular to a siding gauge for hanging siding.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0002] Exterior surfaces of houses and other structures are often protected by exterior siding products made from wood, vinyl, aluminum, bricks, stucco, fiber-cement, and other materials. Composite materials, such as engineered wood and fiber-cement siding products, for example, include panels, planks, and shakes that are installed on plywood or composite walls. To install these siding products, tools have been developed to support a siding during installation.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0003] According to an aspect, a siding gauge is provided that includes a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a first opening in a front of the housing into the through passage, and a second opening in a rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the first opening, a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage, the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel and each having an angled surface, a fastener received in the first and second openings, and a pressure plate positioned in the through passage and coupled to the housing by the fastener, the pressure plate having an angled surface to correspond to the angled surface of the pair of legs, wherein interaction between the angled surface of each of the pair of legs and the angled surface of the pressure plate increases a retention force of the fastener in a primary load direction.

[0004] According to another aspect, a siding gauge is provided that includes a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage for adjusting a reveal height, and a lever pivotable relative to the housing, the lever movable between a first upward closed position to clamp the siding gauge against the siding, a second downward closed position to clamp the siding gauge against the siding, and an open position between the first upward closed position and the second downward closed position to provide slack for positioning the siding gauge.

[0005] According to still another aspect, a siding gauge is provided that includes a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a first opening in a front of the housing into the through passage, a second opening in the front of the housing into the through passage, a third opening in a rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the first opening, and a fourth opening in the rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the second opening, a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage, the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel, a lever pivotable relative to the housing, a retention clip coupled to the housing and movable relative to the housing for adjusting for siding thickness, a first fastener received in the first and third openings for adjusting a reveal height of the support arm, and a second fastener received in the second and fourth openings for pivotally coupling the lever to the housing.

[0006] These and other objects of this application will be evident when viewed in light of the drawings, detailed description and appended claims.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0007] FIG. **1** is a perspective view of an exemplary siding gauge.

[0008] FIG. **2** is front view of the siding gauge.

[0009] FIG. **3** is a cross-sectional view taken along line **3-3** in FIG. **2**.

[0010] FIG. **4** is an exploded view of the siding gauge.

[0011] FIG. **5** is a perspective view of a housing of the siding gauge.

[0012] FIG. **6** is another perspective view of the housing.

[0013] FIG. **7** is a front view of a support arm.

[0014] FIG. **8** is a cross-sectional view taken about line **8-8** in FIG. **7**.

[0015] FIG. **9** is a rear perspective view of the support arm.

[0016] FIG. **10** is a perspective view of the siding gauge with a lever in a first position.

[0017] FIG. **11** is a perspective view of the siding gauge with the lever in a second position.

[0018] FIG. **12** is another perspective view of the siding gauge with the lever in the first position.

[0019] FIG. **13** is a front perspective view of the lever.

[0020] FIG. **14** is a rear perspective view of the lever.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0021] Embodiments of the application relate to methods and systems that relate to a siding gauge. The siding gauge includes a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a first opening in a front of the housing into the through passage, a second opening in the front of the housing into the through passage, a third opening in a rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the first opening, and a fourth opening in the rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the second opening, a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage, the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel, a lever pivotable relative to the housing, a retention clip coupled to the housing and movable relative to the housing for adjusting for siding thickness, a first fastener received in the first and third openings for adjusting a reveal height of the support arm, and a second fastener received in the second and fourth openings for pivotally coupling the lever to the housing. The siding gauge can also include a pressure plate positioned in the through passage and coupled to the housing by the first fastener, wherein each of the pair of legs of the support arm has an angled surface and wherein the pressure plate is angled to correspond to the angled surface of the pair of legs. The lever may be movable between a first closed position to clamp the siding gauge against the siding, an open position to provide slack form positioning the siding gauge, and a second closed position to clamp the siding gauge against the siding.

[0022] With reference to the drawings, like reference numerals designate identical or corresponding parts throughout the several views. The inclusion of like elements in different views does not mean a given embodiment necessarily includes such elements or that all embodiments of the application include such elements. The examples and figures are illustrative only and not meant to limit the application, which is measured by the scope and spirit of the claims.

[0023] Turning now to FIGS. **1-4**, a siding gauge is shown generally at reference numeral **10**. The siding gauge includes a housing **12**, a support arm **14** movable relative to the housing **12** to accommodate siding of different heights and vertical spacings, a lever **16** pivotable relative to the housing **12** to engage/disengage the siding gauge, and a retention clip **18** movable relative to the housing **12** to accommodate siding of different thicknesses. The housing **12**, support arm **14**, and lever **16** may be made of a suitable material, such as plastic to avoid marring of the siding, and the retention clip **18** may be made of a suitable material, such as chrome plating to avoid marring the siding.

[0024] Turning additionally to FIGS. **5** and **6**, the housing **12** includes a through passage **30** extending along its length for receiving the support arm **14**, first and second openings **32** and **34** extending through front of the housing **12** into the passage **30**, third and fourth openings **36** and **38** extending through a back of the housing **12** into the passage **30** aligned with the first and second openings **32** and **34** respectively, and a guide **40** in the passage **30** to guide and maintain orientation of the support arm **14**. The first and third openings **32** and **36** are configured to receive a first fastener **42** perpendicular to or substantially perpendicular to an axis of the passage **30**. The second and fourth openings **34** and **38** are configured to receive a second fastener **44** perpendicular to or substantially perpendicular to the axis of the passage **30**, and the fourth opening **38** is also configured to receive a fastener retainer **46** that couples to the fastener **44**.

[0025] The front of the housing **12** includes markings or indicia, such as indents **50** at the top of the front serving as measurement guide markers for aligning with markings or indicia, such as indents **52** on the support arm **14** serving as reveal measurement guides. The back of the housing **12** defines a cavity **54** for receiving a pad **56**, a cavity **58** for receiving arms **60** of the retention clip **18**, and includes one or more non-marring contact surfaces, such as surface **62** that contacts the siding. The pad **56** may be a rubber pad that abuts a front of the siding during use to prevent marring and increasing clamping friction, and is configured to deform when the lever is moved to one of the closed positions.

[0026] Turning additionally to FIGS. **7-12** and the support arm **14** in detail, the support arm **14** is continuously movable relative to the housing **12** through the passage **30** from the first position shown in FIG. **1** to a plurality of additional positions for use with siding of different heights or siding reveal, such as a second positon shown in FIGS. **10** and **11** indicating a six inch siding reveal and a third position shown in FIG. **12** indicating an eight inch siding reveal.

[0027] The support arm **14** includes a body **70** configured to abut a top of the housing **12** in a first position shown in FIG. **1** and a pair of legs **72** and **74** extending from the body **70** that are moveable through the passage **30** of the housing **12**. The back of the body **70** serves as a tip prevention lip and includes a projection **76** extending from the bottom thereof to serve as a siding rest such that when the siding gauge **10** is installed on a piece of siding, a bottom of the next piece of siding being installed rests on the projection, and a front of the next piece of siding abuts the tip prevention lip. The sides of the projection can define grip areas **78** for a user to grip when adjusting the reveal height of the gauge.

[0028] The legs **72** and **74** are laterally spaced from one another to define a channel **80** that receives the guide **40** in the passage **30** of the housing **12**. The front of each leg **72**, **74** includes a plurality markings or indicia, such as a plurality of the indents **52** incrementally spaced from one another. For example, the leg **72** may include a plurality of indents **52** spaced from one another in centimeter increments with the unit of measure denoted by reference numeral **82** and markings or indicia, such as indents **84** denoting the number of centimeters of the siding reveal. Similarly, the leg **74** may include a plurality of indents **52** spaced from one another in inch increments with the unit of measure denoted by reference numeral **86** and markings or indicia, such as indents **88** denoting the number of inches of the siding reveal, with indents **90** serving as quarter inch increment indicators.

[0029] As best shown in FIGS. **3**, **8** and **9**, the inner surface of each leg **72**, **74** that faces the other leg **72**, **74** to define the channel **80** is angled from back to front such that a portion of each leg **72**, **74** is thicker at its top than at its bottom. The backs of the legs **72** and **74** are configured to abut an angled surface of a pressure plate **92**, which is angled to correspond to the angle of the legs **72** and **74** shown by reference numeral **94**. The pressure plate **92** includes an opening **96** through which the first fastener **42** extends and defines a receptacle **98** on a backside thereof for receiving a lock nut **100** that engages the first fastener **42**, such as via a threaded connection.

[0030] As the first fastener **42** is torqued down, the first fastener applies an axial force on the lock nut **100**, which squeezes the support arm **14** between the pressure plate **92** and the housing **12**, where the torque applied to the first fastener **42** is proportional to a clamping force. The interaction between the angled surface of the legs **72** and **74** and the angled surface of the pressure plate **92** increases the retention force of the first fastener **42** in a primary load direction shown at reference numeral **102**, which eliminates or reduces slippage of the support arm **14** when loaded. The increased retention force allows for the use of non-metal components, such as plastic components, and allows for the use of fasteners that apply a lower torque, such as Philips head screws.

[0031] Turning now to FIGS. **13** and **14**, the lever **16** will be described in detail. The lever **16** is movable between a first upward closed position shown at reference numeral **110** in FIG. **1** and FIG. **10**, an open position shown at reference numeral **112** in FIG. **1** and FIG. **11**, and a second downward closed position shown at reference numeral **114** in FIG. **1**. The lever **16** includes a body **116** for a user to grip and a pair of legs **118** and **120** extending from the body **116** and being laterally spaced from one another. The body **116** includes an area **122** on the front for receiving a label **124** or the like for including information on the product, and an area **126** on the back defining a grip area that may be textured to avoid slippage when gripped by the user.

[0032] Each leg **118**, **120** has an inner portion **130**, **132**, and outer portion **134**, **136**, and a passage **138**, **140** extending through the respective inner and outer portions **130**, **132**, **134**, and **136** in a lateral direction for receiving a pin **142**.

The pin **142** includes an opening **144** for receiving the second fastener **44** to couple the lever **16** to the housing **12** and allow the lever **16** to pivot relative to the housing **12**. The inner portions **130** and **132** are connected to one another by a joint **146**, and define with the joint **146** and the body **116** an opening **148** that allows access to the second fastener **44** when the lever **16** is in the open position **112**. The back each inner portion **130**, **132** defines with the adjacent outer portion **134**, **136** a channel **150**, **152** for receiving a respective projection **64** on the front of the housing **12** when the lever **16** is in the first closed position **110**. The back of each inner portion **130**, **132** also has a cam surface **154**, **156** that presses against the housing **12** in the first closed position **110** to pull the retention clip **18** toward the housing **12** to clamp down the gauge **10**. Similarly, the front of each inner portion **130**, **132** includes a cam surface **158**, **160** that presses against the housing **12** in the second closed position **114** to pull the retention clip **18** toward the housing **12** to clamp down the gauge **10**. When the lever **16** is in the open position **112**, the head of the second fastener **44** will move toward the housing **12** to provide slack for positioning the siding gauge **10** on the siding. Once positioned, the lever **16** can be moved to the first or second closed position to clamp down on the siding.

[0033] Turning again to FIG. **4**, to assemble the siding gauge **10**, the first fastener **42** may be inserted through the first opening **32** in the housing **12** into the passage **30** and the pressure plate **92** and lock nut **110** positioned in the passage **30**. The first fastener **42** is then inserted through the opening **96** in the pressure plate **92** and rotated clockwise to threadably engage the lock nut **110**. The first fastener **42** may be further rotated until an end of the first fastener **42** extends through the third opening **36** in the housing **12**. The pad **56** may be positioned in the cavity **54** on the back of the housing **12** and secured in a suitable manner, such as by an adhesive.

[0034] The pin **142** can be positioned in the passages **138** and **140** of the lever **16** with the opening **144** being positioned between the inner portions **130** and **132**. The lever **16** can then be positioned near the housing **12** and the second fastener **44** inserted through the opening **144** in the pin **142** and the opening **34** in the housing **12**. The fastener retainer **46** can be secured to the retention clip **18** or integrally formed therewith. For example, a projection **170** on the fastener retainer **46** can be received in an opening **172** in the retention clip **18** and secured in a suitable manner, such as by adhesive, welding, etc. A resilient member **174**, such as a compression spring, can be positioned over the fastener retainer **46** and then the fastener retainer **46** inserted into the opening **38** in the housing **12**. The second fastener **44** can then be coupled to the fastener retainer **46**, for example by rotating the second fastener **44** clockwise to threadably engage the second fastener **44** and the fastener retainer **46**. It will be appreciated that although described in a certain order above, the siding gauge **10** may be assembled in any suitable order.

[0035] Turning again to FIGS. **1**, **10** and **11**, operation of the siding gauge **10** will be described in detail. To adjust the reveal height, a user will loosen the first fastener **42** and move the support arm to the desired reveal height if known, for example a six inch reveal height, or the user can hold the siding gauge **10** up to a piece of siding and move the reveal arm to set the reveal height. The support arm **14** is continuously moveable in the passage **30** rather than being moved in preset increments. After the reveal height is set, the user tightens the first fastener **42**, which applies an axial force on the lock nut **100**, which squeezes the support arm **14** between the pressure plate **92** and the housing **12** to hold the support arm **14** at the desired reveal height and prevent slippage if there is a drop or high weight siding.

[0036] The user can then adjust the thickness of the siding gauge, or can adjust thickness prior to setting the reveal height. To adjust the thickness, the user loosens the second fastener **42** to increase the distance between the retention clip **18** and the housing **12**, and then positions the siding gauge **10** on a piece of siding with the lever **16** in either of the first upward closed position or second downward closed position. The user then tightens the second fastener **42** as necessary until the siding gauge **10** is clamped on the siding. The user can then move the lever **16** to the open position creating slack to allow the siding gauge to be removed from the piece of siding. Alternatively, the user can loosen the second fastener **42** to increase the distance between the retention clip **18** and the housing **12**, and then positions the siding gauge **10** on a piece of siding with the lever **16** in the open position. The user then tightens the second fastener **42** as necessary via the opening **148** to hold the siding between the retention clip **18** and housing **12**, for example by hand tightening. When the user then positions the siding gauge **10** onto the siding, movement of the lever to either the first upward closed position or the second downward closed position will provide additional pressure to clamp the siding gauge to the siding.

[0037] Once the reveal height and thickness are set, the siding gauge can be positioned on a piece of siding with the lever **16** in the open position, and then the lever **16** moved to either the first upward closed position or second downward closed position, thereby clamping the siding gauge **10** onto the piece of siding and allowing another piece of siding to be installed.

[0038] The aforementioned systems, components, (e.g., gauges, handles, among others), and the like have been described with respect to interaction between several components and/or elements. It should be appreciated that such devices and elements can include those elements or sub-elements specified therein, some of the specified elements or sub-elements, and/or additional elements. Further yet, one or more elements and/or sub-elements may be combined into a single component to provide aggregate functionality. The elements may also interact with one or more other elements not specifically described herein.

[0039] While the embodiments discussed herein have been related to the apparatus, systems and methods discussed above, these embodiments are intended to be exemplary and are not intended to limit the applicability of these embodiments to only those discussions set forth herein.

[0040] The above examples are merely illustrative of several possible embodiments of various aspects of the present invention, wherein equivalent alterations and/or modifications will occur to others skilled in the art upon reading and understanding this specification and the annexed drawings. In particular regard to the various functions performed by the above described components (assemblies, devices, systems, circuits, and the like), the terms (including a reference to a "means") used to describe such components are intended to correspond, unless otherwise indicated, to any component, such as hardware, software, or combinations thereof, which performs the specified function of the described component (e.g., that is functionally equivalent), even though not structurally equivalent to the disclosed structure which performs the function in the illustrated implementations of the invention. In addition although a particular feature of the invention may have been disclosed with respect to only one of several implementations, such feature may be combined with one or more other features of the other implementations as may be desired and advantageous for any given or particular application. Also, to the extent that the terms “including”, “includes”, “having”, “has”, “with”, or variants thereof are used in the detailed description and/or in the claims, such terms are intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprising.”

[0041] This written description uses examples to disclose the invention, including the best mode, and also to enable one of ordinary skill in the art to practice the invention, including making and using any devices or systems and performing any incorporated methods. The patentable scope of the invention is defined by the claims, and may include other examples that occur to those skilled in the art. Such other examples are intended to be within the scope of the claims if they have structural elements that are not different from the literal language of the claims, or if they include equivalent structural elements with insubstantial differences from the literal language of the claims.

[0042] In the specification and claims, reference will be made to a number of terms that have the following meanings. The singular forms “a”, “an” and “the” include plural referents unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Approximating language, as used herein throughout the specification and claims, may be applied to modify a quantitative representation that could permissibly vary without resulting in a change in the basic function to which it is related. Accordingly, a value modified by a term such as “about” is not to be limited to the precise value specified. In some instances, the approximating language may correspond to the precision of an instrument for measuring the value. Moreover, unless specifically stated otherwise, a use of the terms “first,” “second,” etc., do not denote an order or importance, but rather the terms “first,” “second,” etc., are used to distinguish one element from another.

[0043] As used herein, the terms “may” and “may be” indicate a possibility of an occurrence within a set of circumstances; a possession of a specified property, characteristic or function; and/or qualify another verb by expressing one or more of an ability, capability, or possibility associated with the qualified verb. Accordingly, usage of “may” and “may be” indicates that a modified term is apparently appropriate, capable, or suitable for an indicated capacity, function, or usage, while taking into account that in some circumstances the modified term may sometimes not be appropriate, capable, or suitable. For example, in some circumstances an event or capacity can be expected, while in other circumstances the event or capacity cannot occur—this distinction is captured by the terms “may” and “may be.”

[0044] The best mode for carrying out the invention has been described for purposes of illustrating the best mode known to the applicant at the time and enable one of ordinary skill in the art to practice the invention, including making and using devices or systems and performing incorporated methods. The examples are illustrative only and not meant to limit the invention, as measured by the scope and merit of the claims. The invention has been described with reference to preferred and alternate embodiments. Obviously, modifications and alterations will occur to others upon the reading and understanding of the specification. It is intended to include all such modifications and alterations insofar as they come within the scope of the appended claims or the equivalents thereof. The patentable scope of the invention is defined by the claims, and may include other examples that occur to one of ordinary skill in the art. Such other examples are intended to be within the scope of the claims if they have structural elements that do not differentiate from the literal language of the claims, or if they include equivalent structural elements with insubstantial differences from the literal language of the claims.

1. A siding gauge comprising:

a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a first opening in a front of the housing into the through passage, and a second opening in a rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the first opening;

a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage, the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel and each having an angled surface;

a fastener received in the first and second openings; and

a pressure plate positioned in the through passage and coupled to the housing by the fastener, the pressure plate having an angled surface to correspond to the angled surface of the pair of legs,

wherein interaction between the angled surface of each of the pair of legs and the angled surface of the pressure plate increases a retention force of the fastener in a primary load direction.

2. The siding gauge according to claim **1**, wherein the pressure plate includes an opening for receiving the fastener and defines a receptacle on a backside thereof for receiving a lock nut that engages the fastener.

3. The siding gauge according to claim **2**, wherein the fastener is configured to apply an axial force on the lock nut when a torque is applied to press the support arm between the pressure plate and the housing to increase the retention force.

4. The siding gauge according to claim **1**, wherein each of the pair of legs has an inner surface that faces the inner surface of the other leg to define the channel, wherein each inner surface forms the angled surface.

5. The siding gauge according to claim **4**, wherein each inner surface is thicker at its top than at its bottom, and wherein the pressure plate is thicker at its bottom than at its top.

6. The siding gauge according to claim **1**, further comprising a retention clip coupled to the housing and movable relative to the housing for adjusting for siding thickness.

7. The siding gauge according to claim **1**, further including a lever pivotable relative to the housing.

8. The siding gauge according to claim **7**, wherein the housing includes a third opening in the front of the housing into the through passage and a fourth opening in the rear of the hosing into the through passage and aligned with the third opening, wherein the siding gauge further includes a second fastener received in the third and fourth openings for pivotally coupling the lever to the housing.

9. The siding gauge according to claim **7**, wherein the housing, support arm, and lever are plastic.

10. The siding gauge according to claim **1**, wherein a front of at least one of the pair of legs of the support arm includes a plurality of markings incrementally spaced from one another for setting a reveal height.

11. The siding gauge according to claim **10**, wherein the front of the housing has at least one marking for aligning with one of the plurality of markings on the support arm for indicating the reveal height.

12. A siding gauge comprising:

a housing having a through passage extending along its length;

a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage for adjusting a reveal height; and

a lever pivotable relative to the housing, the lever movable between a first upward closed position to clamp the siding gauge against the siding, a second downward closed position to clamp the siding gauge against the siding, and an open position between the first upward closed position and the second downward closed position to provide slack for positioning the siding gauge.

13. The siding gauge according to claim **12**, wherein the lever includes a body for a user to grip and a pair of legs extending from the body and being laterally spaced from one another.

14. The siding gauge according to claim **13**, wherein a back of each leg includes a cam surface that presses against the housing in the first upward closed position and a front of each leg includes a cam surface that presses against the housing in the second downward closed position.

15. The siding gauge according to claim **12**, further comprising a rubber pad, wherein a back of the housing includes a cavity for receiving the rubber pad, and wherein the rubber pad is configured to deform when the lever is moved to one of the first upward closed position or the second downward closed position.

16. The siding gauge according to claim **12**, wherein the housing has a first opening in a front of the housing into the through passage, a second opening in the front of the housing into the through passage, a third opening in a rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the first opening, and a fourth opening in the rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the second opening, and wherein the siding gauge further includes a first fastener received in the first and third openings for adjusting a reveal height of the support arm, and a second fastener received in the second and fourth openings for pivotally coupling the lever to the housing.

17. The siding gauge according to claim **12**, wherein the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel and each having an angled surface.

18. The siding gauge according to claim **17**, further including a pressure plate positioned in the through passage and coupled to the housing, the pressure plate having an angled surface to correspond to the angled surface of the pair of legs, wherein interaction between the angled surface of each of the pair of legs and the angled surface of the pressure plate increases a retention force of the fastener in a primary load direction.

19. A siding gauge comprising:

a housing having a through passage extending along its length, a first opening in a front of the housing into the through passage, a second opening in the front of the housing into the through passage, a third opening in a rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the first opening, and a fourth opening in the rear of the housing into the through passage and aligned with the second opening;

a support arm movable relative to the housing in the through passage, the support arm including a body and a pair of legs extending from the body, the pair of legs being laterally spaced from one another to define a channel;

a lever pivotable relative to the housing;

a retention clip coupled to the housing and movable relative to the housing for adjusting for siding thickness;

a first fastener received in the first and third openings for adjusting a reveal height of the support arm; and

a second fastener received in the second and fourth openings for pivotally coupling the lever to the housing.

20. The siding gauge according to claim **19**, further including a pressure plate positioned in the through passage and coupled to the housing by the first fastener, wherein each of the pair of legs of the support arm has an angled surface and wherein the pressure plate is angled to correspond to the angled surface of the pair of legs.

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